TIMES AND SEASONS OF LIFE



DAVIDS OLUWASEYE

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ISBN: 978-978-60850-1-2
First edition: September 2024

Cover Design by Precious Abayowa
Layout by Precious Abayo

Published in Nigeria
The Wisdom Publications
thewisdomplaceonline@gmail.com
www.thewisdomplaceonline.com

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Dedication

For in Him I live, and move, and have my being (Acts 17:28). This Book is dedicated to God is the Giver of Wisdom.

Acknowledgement

This book is not just written, it was taught and lived. I had the privilege of mentoring an exceptional team of young men and women over different times on certain onsite and online platforms. It is relevant parts of the content that we taught over the years at these platforms that were worked into the Wisdom for Living Book Series, of which this book is the first. I want to appreciate these uncommon proteges and everyone at the Wisdom Place, House of Insights, and other platforms, most of whom were the first set of students to learn the insights contained in the pages of this book.

The importance of a purpose-driven team to any project cannot be overestimated. The resourceful team which kept me accountable, while doing their quota in ensuring the success of this book includes Precious Akintunde with whom I co-wrote this book. He has a lot of original ideas in various chapters of the book. The team of contributors and editors was led by Otiti Aburime and includes Rachael Oyetade, Ifejesu Majua Odejide and Precious Abayowa who also did the design of this book. Most of the team are also co-instructors with me at The Wisdom Place, The House of Insights and other platforms where I minister.

I do not trivialise the sacrifice of my family in allowing me to do all I do. To my ever loving wife, OluwaNifemi, thank you for your understanding and support. To my adorable sons, Wonders and Wisdom, your lives keep encouraging me never to give up.

To my mentors and various persons who have been instrumental in launching forth this ministry; Pst Sunday Okoh and Pst Temple Omolehin. Our pastors; Apostle Muyiwa Areo and Pastor Temitope Areo, we thank God for the gift of you.

I appreciate God the Father for His Love, Jesus the Son, for His Grace and the Lord Holy Spirit for His Fellowship.

Davids Oluwaseye Ayodele

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Preface

In the journey of success, the adventures and experiences along the path are oftentimes more beneficial and vital than the perks of arrival at the destination. Thus, in the quest for success, the attributes and attitudes one develops and what one becomes due to the demands of the journey are more profound, lasting and beneficial than the things one acquires for getting to the destination.

Like all journeys to the unknown, the value of a tour guide in the journey of life is immeasurable. Wisdom is the principal guide in the journey of life. At every point, Wisdom tells what to do, which way to go, where to take a bend, when to halt, with whom to and not to walk, and guides on many other crucial decisions in the course of the journey. Wisdom prevents from errors thereby increasing one's chances of safe arrival to destiny.

The Wisdom of God is the foundation upon which the entire universe is built. Therefore, access to Divine Wisdom is like having the architect who designed the plans of a very complex mansion to show one around the building. One cannot miss the way when the designer and the blueprint is also the guide.

This book is a compilation of Wisdom, especially as it relates to making a success out of your life, vision and destiny. The principles are simple and profound. They are also based on the God's Word. The principles communicated in this book will encourage, challenge, inspire and enlighten you to become all you could.

CHAPTER 1

THE CONCEPT OF TIMES AND SEASONS

God lives in the realm of eternity but created man to live in the realm of time. One display of God's supremacy over man is His choosing to live in eternity and limiting man's earthly life to time. Therefore, no matter how powerful a human is, the fact that his/her life on earth is subject to time is already an imposed limitation. Time is one of the most profound mysteries of life. Knowing how to relate correctly with time is one of the greatest displays of wisdom. In fact, an urgent consciousness of time in daily life is one of the hallmarks of wisdom. Thus, Psa. 90:12 says, ***teach us to realize the brevity of life, so that we may grow in wisdom (NLT).***

The Creation of Time

Eternity is beyond the scope of our understanding, so it is futile attempting to explain it. Eternity has no beginning but time does. It was at a point along the unveiling of eternity that God decided to create time. In Gen 1:14, ***God commanded lights to appear in the sky and to separate day from night and to show the time for seasons, special days, and years*** (CEV). Thus, time was created on earth and all earthly creatures including man were subject to time. Time is a drop in the ocean of eternity. Imagine a tadpole put in a closed cup, with all the food it needs throughout its short lifespan, and the cup then thrown into an ocean. Asking that tadpole to explain the length, breath, depth, dynamics, physics and chemistry of the ocean is a simpler task than a man within time trying to wrap his mind around explaining eternity and

God who fills all eternity.
Trying to subject God to man's limited understanding or saying God does not exist because one cannot reason Him out is the peak of foolishness. God lives in eternity, we live in time. Time is an atom in the ocean of eternity.

Any measurable time, no matter how large is a grain in the sand dune of eternity. So, a billion or a zillion years is still nothing in the context of eternity. The human mind cannot fathom or explain the Eternal God. This is the reason the Bible says, ***only fools say in their hearts "There is no God." . . . The Lord looks down from heaven on the entire human race; He looks to see if anyone is truly wise, if anyone seeks God*** (Psa.14:1-2). It truly takes a fool to conclude that God does not exist because he cannot explain Him within his limited frame of mind and time. God looks down from the realm of eternity into time to see if there is anyone who is wise enough to know that He exists beyond time and cannot be completely described or subjected within the frame of time.

Understanding Seasons

In Gen 1:14, ***God commanded lights to appear in the sky and to separate day from night and to show the time for seasons, special days, and years.*** One of the reasons God created time is in order to mark seasons. Therefore, time is a subset of eternity and seasons are subsets of time. God created time because He wanted life on earth to be in seasons. Having Seasons on earth is a display of God's wisdom. 'Seasons' is the real beauty of time. Imagine one's entire life time is one long day a long seventy-, eighty- or hundred and something years, spent without day or

Monday or Tuesday, January or December but just one long stretch of time. Imagine you are born, go to school, work, marry, die and do everything on earth within a long continuum of a day without the seasonal coming of night and day, a week after another, month after month or year after year. How would life be? How do you measure progress? How do you rest?

Every day, week, month, and year is organized into seasons for the purpose of order. Day time and night time are seasons of the day. Morning, Afternoon, Evening and Night are seasons within the day. Each day is a season within a week. Each week is a new season within the month. Every New Year is a new season. A year also has different climatic seasons depending on the part of the world. Temperate regions have Autumn, Spring, Winter and Fall. Tropical regions have Rainy Season, Dry Season, and Harmattan. Farm-life has planting seasons, growing seasons, harvest seasons. Each Decade and Millennium is the introduction of a new season.
Even events in life usher new seasons - graduating out of school, getting married, giving birth to children starting a business or career all usher us into new seasons. A new political government brings a state or territory into a new season and so many other examples that depict change in seasons.

The power of seasons lies in the fact that each new season always brings a new hope, opportunity and possibility. Each day we wake with a renewed hope to achieve what we could not the day before. If life on earth was not programmed to be in daily seasons, one major negative effect would be hopelessness and exhaustion. Life would be a too long and tiring journey to the grave. One purpose of seasons is to renew hope; the hope of change, the hope of possibility, the hope of a fresh start and the hope of newness.

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The scripture relates hope to daily renewal of God's mercies. It says, ***Yet, I still dare to hope when I remember this: The faithful love of the Lord never ends! His mercies never cease. Great is his faithfulness; His mercies begin afresh each morning*** (Lam 3: 21 - 23). Seasons are God's wisdom for new beginnings. This is the reason people make new resolutions, goals and targets every New Year. It is the power of season at work. When you fully understand TIMES AND SEASONS OF LIFE as the book will teach, you will not wait for new years to bring new seasons into your life, you will know how to appoint seasons to yourself.
Life is all about seasons. Living a great life is all about maximizing each season of life. A common mistake in life is people wishing and praying for a great life while neglecting to greatly utilize the season of life they are in. A great live is simply a sum total of greatness of each season of life.

The Season for a Purpose and the Purpose of a Season

Understanding seasons and knowing the purpose for each season is the domain of the wise. Eccl 3:1 says, ***to everything there is a season, a time for every purpose under heaven*** (NKJV). This means that to get life right, there is a season to do everything you are to do. Doing things out of season is one of the greatest reasons for failure in life. The question of life is not 'will I be successful and great?' The real question of life is 'Am I doing what I should be doing now so that I can have a life of success and greatness? Prov. 10:5 ***says He who gathers in summer is a wise son; He who sleeps in harvest is a son who causes shame.*** This scripture is not portraying sleep as bad, rather, it is stating that sleeping at a season when you should be working will lead to shame. The person that does not plant during planting season will have nothing to take home during harvest season.

Wisdom is knowing what to do at each season of your life.
There is a season for every purpose and there is a purpose for season. It is equally great wisdom to learn to discern the purpose of the seasons of your life. Whatever you are going through right now, good or bad, when you discern correctly the purpose of the season, you cooperate maximally with it and make maximum use of it. You may be going through a not-so-desirable season in your life but until you discover the purpose for it and co-operate with the purpose, you may be stuck in it. Sometimes, there are lessons to pick, character and attitudes to develop, changes in thinking and lifestyle to imbibe, and/or skills to come out of difficult season. If you do not understand the purpose of the season but keep complaining about the season, the struggle continues until one understands the purpose for the season and does what they are supposed to do.
You may also be going through a great season in life, have you discovered the reason for the season? When the reason for a season is not known, the season is wasted. Wisdom is knowing what to do at each season of your life.

In Gen 41, Pharaoh had a dream which Joseph interpreted to mean that there would be a season of abundance for seven years in Egypt followed by a season of famine for seven years. Joseph further advised that the purpose of the season of abundance was to save up for the season of dearth. The truth is that whether this counsel was taken or not, the seasons of abundance and famine would have come all the same. It took a man of wisdom to make them understand the purpose of the season of abundance. According to Gen41: 53 - 54, ***At last the seven years of bumper crops throughout the land of Egypt came to an end. Then the seven years of famine began, just as Joseph had predicted. The famine also struck all the surrounding countries, but throughout Egypt there was plenty of food.***

The preservation of an entire civilization was hinged on their understanding the purpose of a season. When people do not understand TIMES AND SEASONS OF LIFE, they suffer and struggle at best and die at the very worst.

There have been people who had a season of abundance in their lives but because they did not know the purpose of the season, they squandered the season and never recovered from the loss. It is wisdom to know the season for every purpose and activity in your life and it is even greater wisdom to know the purpose for every season of your life.

CHAPTER 2

The Phases of Life

A life time is too brief for one to achieve all its potentials and possibilities. This is the reason we must treat life with a sense of urgency in achieving our goal. As the scripture says, teach us to realize the brevity of life, so that we may grow in wisdom. Obviously, that there, is a strong relationship between understanding the Times and Seasons of life and wisdom. Furthermore, your use of time is a direct measure of how much wisdom you possess.

The Phases of Life

Life is in phases and we must maximize every phase of life so that our overall life-journey results in success. It is our understanding of the phases of life that makes us know what we are supposed to do per time in life. 1 Chron. 12:32 talks about the ***men of Issachar, who understood the times and knew what Israel should do -200 chiefs, with all their relatives under their command*** (NIV). When people understand times and Seasons, they know what they should do at every time and they become commanders in life.

The phases of life as described below are idealistic. First, it is based on a lifetime of 100 years and we know that many people do not live up to a hundred. Secondly, it divides a life time into four even parts; and, we all know that life is not even. A phase of life might stretch longer than evaluated for one person and be less than evaluated for another. Two people born on the same day will not die on the same day and will not

die on the same day and will not achieve milestones the same time. This is the reason life is not to be lived in comparing ourselves, achievement, time or progress against another person or a general standard. This would create undue pressure and a sense of ingratitude for life if one is behind the abstract standard or a sense of pride in some of people who believe their achievement is in phase with the standard. Bible says that self-comparison with another person is not wise. Thus, 2 Cor. 10:12 says, ***for we will not make comparison of ourselves with some of those who say good things about themselves: but these, measuring themselves by themselves, and making comparison of themselves with themselves, are not wise.*** (BBE)

The intent and advantage of the model is that it create understanding as to what one ought to focus on per time in life and helps one to keep an entire lifetime in view in daily life. Thus, be grateful to God for where your life is right now as you keep working diligently towards life progress, not because you are racing against time-phases of achievement set by man but because you are urgent towards fulfilling your purpose and destiny in life.

The phases of life are:

1. The Learning/Formative Phase of Life: This is the time when value is acquired, developed and mastered. At this phase, traits, skills and discipline for success are learnt and built up. This is the time to invest, make sacrifices and delay gratification. It is absolutely unnecessary to be seeking to harvest all the fruits of one's investment at this time. This is also the phase where one should make all the mistakes and learn in life.
Like the fractured bone of a child heals faster than that of adults, mistakes made during the formative phase of life are easier to correct than the ones made later.

Life coaches put this phase for the ideal life at age 0 to 25 years. This time range is fixed not to mean that once one has passed this age, the person cannot learn to position for success anymore. The time fixation is to create a sense of urgency. Indeed, if one has past this age and has not attained mastery in what one intends to be great at, one is running behind schedule and needs to be more urgent about developing the values needed for success. Subsequently, we will liken this phase to the morning time of life.

2. The Earning/Deployment Phase of Life: After value has been developed in the learning phase, it needs to be deployed for rewards of success. At this phase of life, one should necessarily be dispensing his gifts to his generation and should have started living one's dreams. Moreover, rewards of success, at different levels, should have started coming in. Nonetheless, this is not the time to stop learning and investing into oneself, it is time to even improve on what one does on the job and no longer in the dream-room. Some level of results must be evident in this phase. At the culmination of this phase, one should seek to attain his highest life potential. Success coaches have set this phase at age 25 – 50 years. As earlier said, if at fifty a person has not attained the fullest potential, it does not mean such a person is undone, it does mean that one should live with a greater sense of urgency though. In this book, we liken this phase to the afternoon of life.

3. The Legacy Phase of Life: This is the time to be more intentional in raising successors and developing a system for the perpetuation of one's impact by the next generation. It is wise to shift one's focus from investing more into oneself to investing into others that will continue the legacy. At this age, you should have raised people that are the extension of your greatness and who will continue to deploy your value even when you are no more.

The expected age-range for the legacy phase of life is from 51 to 75 years. People in this age range that cannot point to other people they have raised into greatness may be in for failure in the long-run even if they succeeded in their personal lives. We shall refer to this as the evening of life.

3. The Retirement Phase of Life. This is the time to hand over to the next generation and be coaching from the sidelines. If death comes any time between 76 to 100 years, it should meet one fulfilled and having lived a full life. This is the night of life.

It is important to re-emphasize that the above categorization is not based on scriptures but life-coaches simply use this to give a greater understanding of life and what should be done per time. So, do not get into a needless race against time that you must do something by sometime by all means or feel defeated because you are at a certain age and certain things have not happened. A sense of urgency in life is different from a sense of desperation.

The main point of this chapter is for you to remember that life is brief and there should be things we ought to be doing and attaining progressively per time in life. So, we need to be even more deliberate and live with a greater sense of urgency than portrait in the ideal stratification shown above.

CHAPTER 3

The Life-Time and the Times of Life

God in His Wisdom created life to be in seasons because anything short of that would create a tiring life of hopelessness. Our advantage in life is in understanding the seasons of life - knowing what each season is meant for and using each season accordingly.

Every day has different seasons - the morning, the afternoon, the evening and the night. To have a great day, one must maximize all the seasons of the day. Thus, knowing what to do in the morning, how to maximize the afternoon, what is suited for the evening, and what is best done in the night, makes an entire day profitable.

For example, it is important to create time to seek God in the morning and spiritually order the day aright. It is also vital to have a time carved out of every day when you feed your spirit, soul and mind with empowering information through books, messages, speeches or videos that fuel your drive towards your life goals. There should be ample time every day for productivity and working at things that moves you forward in your vision, career, and finances. Thus, work time is vital in every day.

Additionally, there should also be a part of the day, which has to be created, that you spend alone with yourself for personal reflection, planning, thinking, envisioning and meditation.

Your day must have a time to exchange love with other people; give and receive love from family, friends and acquaintances. There should be a time for rest in each day. There should also be time carved out for impacting the world of people around you. Community outreach, getting involved in a ministry, serving in a church unit, being part of a social/humanitarian endeavor must have an allocated time in your life no matter how busy you are.
While touching lives and reaching out in impact to others should be ingrained in your everyday life, carrying out outreaches to others, getting involved in ministry service and other organized impact endeavors may not be every day for someone whose primary work is not related to such.

However, thinking one is too busy to have time to do something that involves serving God or touching lives around is a deception. The truth is that life is always busy, people must learn to create time for the priorities and what must be done.
The reason some people live an entire lifetime, absorbed in self, meeting up with the demands of life and having no one impacted as a legacy that they lived is because they do not understand that time for service to humanity, ministry and impact must be calculated into life, no matter how busy you are.

Part of wisdom for living is knowing that time to make impact on others, serve God or be part of an organized impact system. It is not wisdom to be above thirty years old and there are not people who can attribute something in the making of their lives to the impact of your life - and these people should not be your immediate family alone.

The Times of Life

There are seasons within a day and there are the seasons within a lifetime. As obtained with the times of the day, there is also the morning, afternoon, evening and night of life. Wisdom is knowing and doing what each time of life is meant for. Eph. 5:15-17 expounds, ***see then that ye walk circumspectly, not as fools, but as wise, redeeming the time, because the days are evil. Wherefore be ye not unwise, but understanding what the will of the Lord is.***

It is obvious, once again, that there is a strong relationship between wisdom and usage of time. Every day of life have been programmed by default to go wrong by the 'Fall of man', it is your duty to make sure your own day goes right. Unless you seize the times of the day by the horns and make it yield what it needs to deliver to you, it will slip through the hands and time will be going without it making a commensurate contribution to your life progress.

Eph. 5:15-17 NLT says, ***so, be careful how you live. Don't live like fools, but like those who are wise. Make the most of every opportunity in these evil days. Don't act thoughtlessly, but understand what the Lord wants you to do.*** Redeeming the time involves taking advantage of the opportunities every time presents to you, maximizing every second of life and making sure no time is wasted.

There are opportunities that inherent in the morning of life, there are those to be seized at noon. Wisdom makes you know what is best reserved for the evening time and night of life hunting when they should be resting. Postponing what should be done in the morning of life to the noon is foolishness. Doing in the morning what is reserved for the night is lack of wisdom. Wisdom is doing the right thing at the right time.

A scriptural example of the understanding of what to do at each time of life is shown in Gen. 49: 27. It says, "***Benjamin is a ravenous wolf; in the morning he shall devour the prey, and at night he shall divide the spoil.***" Benjamin, like a wolf, understands that the morning is for hunting prey and evening is for eating the meat. Lack of wisdom makes some people to eat all the meat in the morning so they have nothing to eat at night. This is the reason some have to still be hunting when they should be resting.

The Times of Life

Just as the day, life could be partitioned into the morning, afternoon, evening and night. Knowing what to do at every time of life is the secret to greatness in life. The Bible uses the analogy of the day to portray human lifetime, it says, ***for you, a thousand years are as a passing day, as brief as a few night hours. You sweep people away like dreams that disappear. They are like grass that springs up in the morning. In the morning it blooms and flourishes, but by evening it is dry and withered*** (Psa. 90:4 - 6). Figuratively, people are born and they spring in the morning, grow in the noon, become dry in the evening, and wither and die at night.

The Morning Life

The morning of life starts from the time of birth to the time of youth. The morning of life orders the entire life just like the morning of the day orders the entire day. Contemporary research has shown that very successful people are people who wake up early and maximize the wee hours of the day. Literally, great people wake up early and work before others wake.

Entire books and focus groups have been created on the power of maximizing the morning of each as one of the habits that set apart highly effective people apart from mediocrities in life. Similarly, exceptionally successful people in life are often those who get their paths in life right early. Just as ample use of the morning of the day determines how efficient and productive a day is, maximizing the morning of life determines how great a life would be. In order words, to have a great life, you must wake up to pursuing your destiny in life early.

It is amazing when young people in their twenties finish school and popular culture says they are about to start life. The question is 'what have they been doing all the while?' 'Playing life?' It is deception for someone in their twenties to think that are still in rehearsals for life. No, you are already live on the stage of life! Your life is far gone, you are already getting too old - the morning is over.

A Nigerian adage says 'the morning is the entire day'. There are variants of this same adage in most cultures and languages, attempting to emphasize the fact that whatever needs to get done in a day is best done early in the morning. Thus, whatever makes teens, early twenties, or parents think that they are still in the nursery of life is a big deception. The morning of life is when the manifestation of how well and how far one will go in life has to start. A man/woman that will be great starts manifesting greatness in the morning.

The essence of this is for young people, most especially, to quit thinking they are children and to take life by the horns. Also, for parents, to stop pampering and protecting grown-ups under their roofs.

The dawn of life, which is the earliest part of the morning of life, is to teach eternal values, principles and virtues that would be a compass for a person throughout life. If this was well-done by parents and guardian, they should trust God and what they have taught their children enough to start allowing them step into their destinies.

Prov. 22:6 ***says, train up a child in the way he should go: and when he is old, he will not depart from it.*** Childhood is the earliest stage of the morning of life - the dawn of life. This is the time for training. It is important to ingrain sound doctrine, character, godliness, responsibility, and principles strongly into children between the ages of zero to twelve; else, the entire subsequent efforts would be remedial measures. However, people in their teens are to be exposed to responsibility. A wise man once said, the concept of adolescent is being used to excuse foolishness in many people. The truth about life is that you are either a child or an adult, and you become an adult when you are no longer a child. 1 Cor. 13:11-12 says, ***when I was a child, I spoke and thought and reasoned as a child. But when I grew up, I put away childish things.*** Thus, according to scriptures, you stop being a child when you grow up. Some grow up in their teens, some in their twenties, some in their forties, some never grow up.

Things to do in the morning life

1. **Seek and Know God:** Ps. 63:1 says ***O God, thou art my God; early will I seek thee: my soul thirstiest for thee, my flesh longest for thee in a dry and thirsty land, where no water is.*** Isa. 55:6 says, ***seek ye the Lord while he may be found, call ye upon him while he is near.*** This suggests that a time comes when it is more difficult to seek God if you have not done so earlier.

Ask anyone in the noon and evening of their lives, they will tell you of some many legitimate demands of life that makes them not to have as much time for spiritual pursuits, retreats, programs, outreaches like during the morning of their lives. The people who are spiritually strong in the noon and evening of life are those that have developed a reservoir of spiritual grace in the morning of life.

2. **Discover your purpose and direction in life:** Isa. 50:4 says the Lord God hath given me the tongue of the learned, that I should know how to speak a word in season to him that is weary: he waketh morning by morning, he waketh mine ear to hear as the learned. God wants you to hear every morning the instructions and guidance for the day. He even more wants you to hear early in the morning of life the instructions, guidance, and direction for your life. It is an untold advantage when you discover your purpose early in life; it sets your life on the right course and makes your decisions to be error free from the start of life.

3. **Build and Invest for the future:** the morning of life is not the time for consumption but for investment. This is the time to invest your time, talents, resources and money into building for the future. Eccl. 10:16 - 17 says ***woe to thee, O land, when thy king is a child, and thy princes eat in the morning! Blessed art thou, O land, when thy king is the son of nobles, and thy princes eat in due season, for strength, and not for drunkenness!*** Some people eat their future in the morning by the luxuries they buy. The morning is not the time for rest; why not delay gratification till evening? It is not wrong to eat some things but it has to be in due season. There are due TIMES AND SEASONS OF LIFE for eating certain things. Some people are struggling in their marriages because they have 'eaten' all the sex they could in the morning.

At noon and evening, their appetite has become insatiable. Some have 'eaten' all the money and do not have anything laid up for the evening. The morning is not for consumption, it is for investment.
If someone misses the opportunities meant for the morning of life, such a person may end up merely trying to play catch-up throughout life. While God's mercy can locate anyone and still make something out of their lives even if they discover God or get serious with life late, the indisputable point is that God is best found in the morning of life and life is better when it is gotten right early in life.

Often times, people are quick to mention some people who started late in life and still succeeded. However, for every two people they use as examples of people who did not come to God early in life and still made it, there are 98 that did not get life early and never recovered from the loss. We cannot base principles on the exemption but on the rule.

A number of people are quick to point out how Abraham stepped out into destiny at the age of seventy and still made it and thereby claim that it does not matter the time one gets it right in destiny. It is important to know that Abraham was an exemption in this regards and not the rule. First, you may not live up to 175 years like Abraham (Gen 25: 7). Meaning that, Abraham stepped into destiny at seventy and had a hundred and five years to fulfill it. Secondly, for one Abraham in the Bible that stepped out late, there are ninety-nine heroes that stepped out early. So, let us quit building our theologies based on the exemption which is a show of God's sovereignty but on the rule which is the show of God's principles.

The Noon of Life

The noon of life is the time for establishment and dominion. This is the time when you rise to the peak of what God wants you to do in life. While the morning is the time for starting in life, the noon is the time for building in life. Eccl. 11:6-7 says, *plant your seed in the morning and keep busy all afternoon, for you don't know if profit will come from one activity or another—or maybe both.* You should be busy building a career, ministry, home, business, impact and God's Kingdom.

On a regular day, when you see someone sleeping in the afternoon, they are either lazy or sick - except they worked night shifts. However, the noon comes before the night in life so the one who sleeps in the noon of life is not because he worked a night shift but because he is planning to work a night shift. If you do not want to be working when you should be resting and mentoring others, you should work in the noon.

This is the time when your life work must be full-fledged. *Jesus said I must work the works of him that sent me, while it is day: the night cometh, when no man can work* (John 9:4). You should pursue life with such urgency at the noon like that is all you have to fulfill your destiny, purpose and goals. After the noon, diminishing returns may overtake your physical strength and you may have to go at an easier pace in life. So, run in your youth - the morning and the noon. According to Lam.3:27, *it is good for a man that he bear the yoke in his youth.*

Things to do at Noon

1. **Take responsibility and become self-dependent:** While a large part of the morning is spent as being dependent on parents and guardian, one should have learned self-reliance in the late morning of life and become self-dependent in the noon. The noon is not the time to be feeding on parents, friends and relatives. It is a time when your hands should be sufficient for you. Deut. 33:7 shows the blessing of Judah: saying, ***Hear, Lord, the voice of Judah, and bring him unto his people: let his hands be sufficient for him; and be thou a help to him from his enemies.*** By the time you get to the noon of life, your hands must be sufficient for you and you should not be dependent on someone.

2. **Get establishment in life and purpose:** The noon is the time for establishment. It is God's will that one gets established early in life. According to Psa. 46: 5, ***God is in the midst of her; she shall not be moved: God shall help her and that right early.*** God wants you to be established in your life assignment, vision, business, finances, marriage and career early. By noon, you should have started all the necessary areas of life and commit to building them. Why should you wait till after retirement from a career to start a business? The timeline is inappropriate and most people that do it fail at it. The noon is the time to establish things; start that business in your noon, even as a career person and build it along with your career. You should retire from your job at the evening into the business you have built alongside in the afternoon, not retire in the evening to start business. Also, like someone said, 'it is not cool to be raising kids with your pension' - establish your home early it is daytime of your life.

3. **Build your life:** The noon is the strongest part of your life and it should be spent building what you will do with your life. You will discover at the dusk of life that it is what you spent your noontime building that you will be able to point to eventually. Build your family, business, ministry, career with your 'noon' strength. Don't hold back at noon; go all out with the strength of your youth to build what you will leave as a legacy in every area of your life.

4. **Achievement is for the noon:** Largely, the noon time is supposed to be the peak of productivity of the day. Having maximized the morning, the noon should be the peak period of the day. There is usually a slowing down of pace in the evening. The night is the time for rest. However, if by afternoon one has still not gone far in the work for the day, then the day has slipped off one's hand.

The Evening and Night of Life

The strength of youth will not always be there. Part of wisdom is living with a time consciousness. Therefore, the days of youth must be maximized. Your youth largely talks about the morning and afternoon of your life. The evening is the time to consolidate on the achievement of the day and actualize whatever elongates beyond life work hours. In natural life, we all have had reasons to stay back at work after official closing hours and work into the evening because the day is spent and the work is not completed. So, evening is not for resignation, it is still for work. You should work in the evening as long as your life targets are not yet met and your life's fullest potentials are not fulfilled. However, the truth is that once evening comes, the tempo of work drops because of the exhaustion of the long haul of the day.

This is the reason it is important to do what is most important in the day and invest the best part of your energy into what matters most early in life. The strength for work in the evening is not the same as in the day - the morning and noon. Furthermore, when the night comes, it is time to sleep. This is the reason Jesus said, ***I must work the works of him that sent me, while it is day: the night cometh, when no man can work*** (John 9:4).

The Bible gives a classic description of what happens once the evening and night of life catches up with a person. ***In Eccl. 12:1-5, it says, Don't let the excitement of youth cause you to forget your Creator. Honor him in your youth before you grow old and say, "Life is not pleasant anymore." Remember him before the light of the sun, moon, and stars is dim to your old eyes, and rain clouds continually darken your sky. Remember him before your legs—the guards of your house—start to tremble; and before your shoulders—the strong men—stoop. Remember him before your teeth—your few remaining servants—stop grinding; and before your eyes—the women looking through the windows—see dimly. Remember him before the door to life's opportunities is closed and the sound of work fades. Now you rise at the first chirping of the birds, but then all their sounds will grow faint. Remember him before you become fearful of falling and worry about danger in the streets; before your hair turns white like an almond tree in bloom, and you drag along without energy like a dying grass hopper, and the caper berry no longer inspires sexual desire. Remember him before you near the grave, your everlasting home, when the mourners will weep at your funeral*** (NLT). Fools spend the evening carousing, average people spend the evening resting, and wise people spend the evening planning for the next day.

When you see people in their fifties, sixties and seventies still gallivanting and rocking life as if they are still young - partying, carousing with the girls and boys, and riding life in funfair, you have met a great fool. No matter the achievement such people had in their morning and nights, they are not planning for tomorrow.

There is a tomorrow in the time of life; your tomorrow is your next generation - your children, legacy, and the future of what you have spent your life building. When you see people in their fifties, sixties and seventies retiring into a life of laxity, you have met an average person. What to do in the evening is to build the next generation and transfer the baton to them. Spend your noon raising and building people as you also build structures. Spend the evening of your life, pouring all the wealth of your wisdom and experience into the next generation and make sure you transfer all your vision, wisdom, and systems into the hands of younger people you have raised so that when night comes and you go to sleep, you can be rest assured that what you spent your entire life on will outlive you.

It is vanity to spend all your life building something that dies when you die because, in a little while, the story of such a person would sound the same with that of someone who never built. Every worthwhile vision you have must stretch beyond your lifetime even from inception. In other words, you must factor how every vision you have now would thrive and grow after you are gone. As you build your God-given vision, you must build the system to be able to eventually do without you. Identify potential successors from the noon of your life, build them along as you build the vision, invest in the people and make them wiser, better and mightier than you.

Plan succession and transfer the leadership to them in the evening. Don't let death take leadership from you and enforce it into an unready system. It is better to transfer leadership to the next generation and be around to mentor them on the job as a coach in the evening before the night of your life.

Every wise person has younger people around him/her that he or she is working with and building into their life assignments through his vision. Anyone that does not have younger people from a younger generation that he/she is intentionally and strategically building into his vision is not being wise. Also, note that there is a difference between using people and building them. A major difference is that when you are building people, you are dealing with them as leaders and seeing them as people who will eventually take your place and do the things you are doing. When you are using people, you are seeing them as people who will ever be under you so that they can help you rise higher and higher. In building, the focus is the people - you see yourself as existing for them. In using, focus is you - you see the people as existing for you and your vision. It is also worthy of note that some of the people you built may not continue in the system you built but continue or start another system entirely, however, that system is still an extension of you even if it does not necessarily bear your name. It is important to know this because I have met leaders who are reluctant to build people because they nurse the pain of having built some people and those people did not use the building for the legacy of the system that leader is seeking its legacy but went elsewhere or started their own system. Those leaders with such complaints are those who are building people quite alright but still have the motive of 'using' people.

A true builder is not building men because he wants to be the one that will carry his vision and legacy.

A true builder of men builds men because that is his heart. Such may build a hundred men and only one eventually is the one that carries their vision to the next level but they are still happy and proud of the ninety-nine succeeding in their own right as well. It is God's justice to allocate the person that will take your legacy to the next level to you. However, it is your duty to keep raising men without insisting that the people you raised must bear your name and serve your course. This is the selfless demand of wisdom for Trans-generational legacy.

Know the importance of the season you're in and a wise son you will be. But what a waste when an incompetent son Prov 10: 5 TPT

CHAPTER 4

THE COURSE OF LIFE PREDESTINATION AND CHIOCES

The Course of Life

When a person gets the course of life and the times of life right, such person is headed for greatness, fulfillment and success. The course of life talks about the sequential unraveling of events and the progression of happenings in one's life. The course of life- the events along the paths of a life, determines where a life is headed. It is important to pay great attention to the course of one's lives and make sure it is trending in the positive direction.

One of the areas of confusion in people ordering the course of their lives is in understanding the balance between God's predestination and human choices. There are people who believe that the events, courses and timings of life are predestined by God and merely unfold as we live on earth. Thus, there are people who believe that there is virtually nothing a person can do outside of God's solid-cast predestination for them. These 'fatalists' believe that God is the author and designer of every man's destiny and each person merely lives out God's script for them. Thus, 'the rich is rich because God willed it and the poor is poor because God willed it', so they believe.

On the other opposite end of the spectrum are those who believe that man is the architect of his destiny and ultimate pilot of the course of his life. These categories of people believe that predestination is a farce and man rules his life by his choices. The extremists in this school of thought have even suggested that God is a myth and man is the grand commander of his own destiny. Some milder point of view in this humanistic philosophy believe that God exists but does not determine the destiny of anyone - each person's life is ultimately what he or she makes of it. Man, they say, is the master of his fate.

Therefore, it is important to get answers and discover the truth and balance in the above points of view. Does God have a predestined and preordained outcome for each person's lives? Is the outcome of everyone's life absolutely based on their choice or God's preordination? Are these two mutually exclusive - meaning, is it either one or the other? Are they mutually inclusive – meaning, can both concepts work together?

The answers to the above questions will be discovered in this chapter and the truths will be revolutionary for those that apply them.

The Mystery of Predestination

Ps. 139:13-18 expresses vital thoughts on the concept on predestination: ***You made all the delicate, inner parts of my body and knit me together in my mother's womb. Thank you for making me so wonderfully complex! Your workmanship is marvelous—how well I know it. You watched me as I was being formed in utter seclusion, as I was woven together in the dark of the womb. You saw me before I was born. Every day of my life was recorded in your book. Every moment was laid out before a single day had*** passed. ***How precious are your thoughts about me, O God. They cannot*** be ***numbered! I can't even count them; they outnumber the grains of sand! And when I wake up, you are still with me***! (NLT).

What a statement, *'You saw me before I was born. Every day of my life was recorded in your book. Every moment was laid out before a single day had passed'!* This scripture shows that God has actually written out things about every person even before they come to the earth. It proves that people are deployed by God to the earth to live out what is written concerning them. As written in Heb.10:7-9, Christ said, '***Look, I have come to do your will, O God—as is written about me in the Scriptures.***' Therefore, Jesus our perfect example had His destiny written and set before He came to the earth.

Any one that understands scriptures know that preordination and predestination are truths in God. In Jer.1: 5, we see that before Jeremiah was born, God had predetermined what He wanted to become of him. Jer.1:5 says, ***"I knew you before I formed you in your mother's womb. Before you were born I set you apart and appointed you as my prophet to the nations".*** This announcement came before Jeremiah started the ministry God committed into his hand. God obviously predestines and preordains, it is everyone's duty to discover their preordination and walk in it.

Rom. 8:29-30 says, ***for whom He foreknew, He also predestined to be conformed to the image of His Son, that He might be the firstborn among many brethren. Moreover whom He predestined, these He also called; whom He called, these He also justified; and whom He justified, these He also glorified.*** God truly has what He has written in His books concerning everyone. Rev. 20:12 records, ***and I saw the dead, small and great, stand before God; and the books were opened: and another book was opened, which is the book of life: and the dead were judged out of those things which were written in the books, according to their works*** (NKJV). The Book of Life is where the name of everyone who receives eternal salvation through Jesus Christ is written.

The other books are books of records where the preordinations and the actual deeds of everyone who came to the earth are written. On the day of judgment, everyone's deeds will be measured against their preordinations; if all one's deeds are out of alignment the preordained assignment, then the entire work-done is judged zero. Many religions have emphasized imminent judgment based on the record of the good deeds versus bad deeds of men but do not make people conscious of coming judgment based on the record of the believer's preordination versus their actual course lived. The book of preordination and record determine rewards while the Book of Life, on its own part, decides eternal abode - heaven or hell. A lot of believers are taught that rewards in heaven are based on good deeds on earth. They miss the vital truth that reward in heaven is assignment-based. You must know that God does not reward you just because you do the good things but because you do the right things. The right things are the things that He has preordained for you to do. Thus, the ultimate questions on the last day are two - Did you accept Jesus Christ as savior and Lord while on earth? Did you do the things that you were sent to the earth to do? Every other question is an addendum.

Predestination Versus Choice?

When a truth is misapplied or misappropriated, it produces the same effect as a lie. It is true that the course of every person's life has been preordained but it is not true the events of people's lives have been cast-in-stone by God, such that things are bound to happen in a person's life by God's preordination with or without the person's participation.

God is a God of purpose and His purpose for a matter is described by the resultant end of the matter. Thus, for everything God does, He has an intended end in mind. In other words, there is something God is trying to achieve in everything He does. Therefore, God said, ‘I declare the end from the beginning, and from ancient times things that are not yet done, Saying, 'My counsel shall stand, And I will do all My pleasure’ (Isa. 46:10). This statement means that what God is trying to do and, the end He has in mind is preordained and must surely happen. Thus, God preordains the resultant end but He is flexible in the means to achieve the end.

Generally, in life, the end is superior to the means. In fact, the end determines if the means is worthwhile or not. The end talks about what one is trying to achieve, the means describes how one goes about achieving it. If the means outweighs the end, purpose has been defeated. Therefore, means may change even when the end is fixed.

God declares the end from the beginning! Thus, God is very interested in the end and therefore, God predestined the end. In other words, what God is trying to achieve in every situation is cast in stone and has been predestined to be surely achieved because God cannot fail. However, God changes the means to achieve His end due to the choices of the human factors involved.

The reason for confusion among many people on the issue of preordination and choices is in not realizing that every human being, the entirety of the human race and all the events of the lifetimes of the entire people who have lived on the earth, with all the courses of all their lives on earth - are all part of the means to an end. The end, which is God’s ultimate purpose, is higher than each of us and every one of us.

This is why, despite the truth of predestination, nothing is irrevocably fixed for anyone as a predestined personal life outcome. Volume one of this book series makes us to understand that the end of all things in God's mind is 'His Kingdom Come' eternally on the earth. The series of events that are fixed for the Kingdom Story to be fulfilled MUST happen by predestination. The human agents that will fulfill the predestination will do so based on their choices.

For example, God predestined that Divinity would come to the earth, born by a virgin without sin, and would deliver humanity from sin and Satan. That was an end to be achieved; every other thing that happened from the fall of man to the coming of Jesus was a means to that end. Every man and woman that played a role from Adam to Abraham to David to the ascension of Jesus Christ in the story of Redemption did so based on their choices. If they did not, God would have passed through someone else to get the preordination of salvation fulfilled because the story was predestined to be fulfilled.

Right now, there is the predestination that the kingdoms of the earth and all the spheres and sectors of the world system will bow to the Lordship of Jesus, the people that will fulfill this preordination in each different sphere of the world will partner with it by their choices. Also, we are currently on earth to practice dominion and qualify for the level of kingdom rule we can be trusted with when the Kingdom of God comes physically upon the earth. We qualify for levels of influence in the Soon Coming Kingdom by our present level demonstration of Kingdom interest and dominion in today's world as the Kingdom is being won.

Jesus is coming back to restate the Kingdom on the earth and rule and reign with His saints. Satan and His cohorts will be judged and thrown into eternal damnation. A new earth and a new heaven will be made and we will rule over the systems of the earths as co-regents with Jesus Christ. All these are predestined event but the roles, timings and alignment of individuals and systems is based on their choices.

Infinite Routes to Fulfill Predestined End

God has infinite ways and possibilities in His Infinite-Mind on how each end result can be achieved. Thus, He preordains events and people into roles in order to achieve His predestined end. However, if anyone is not aligned by their choices along the path of predestination, they have not hurt the plan; they have only denied themselves the privilege of being part of the plan. There are infinite options of people and events that God can pass through as means to His predestined end. Because He is God - all the means are programmed into His predestination from the onset so there is a predestined role for everyone but not cast-in-stone for them.

The reason people get confused about predestination is because they think their lives is ‘an end’. So, they view predestination from the myopic perspective of ‘predestination for their lives’. No! Your life is a ‘means to an end’. The predestination is not about you, it is about something you are to do which is merely a work function in the eternal predestined project of God. Thus, if you do not do it, it will still be done nonetheless. It is important to note that your life, marriage, business, career, ministry, academics and so on, are all means. God’s kingdom coming is the end. People regard their lives as an end because they are judging life based on their micro-view of self.

God has things He is trying to achieve in your world, territory, city, family that He has predestined to happen. You are part of the predestined means to that predestined end. But remember that means are changeable, plans are revisable and people are disposable. Thus, predestination is real but every person is only an available alternative as a means in achieving God's predestined end. So, you have a predestined role to play in God's scheme of predestined purpose. The role must be played and the end result must happen. However, whether it is you that will play the role and how far you will go in playing the role depends on your choices.

The Powers inherent in Man

God has ordained the events, timings and course of life for every person before they were born but it is completely their choices to be aligned or unaligned with it. God has given much power to man and He will never violate it even to get His utmost will done. Thus, God has a predestination for everyone but it is their choice to discover it and fulfill it. Even though He predestined it, He will not enforce it outside of the person's will. This is why God taught us to pray, '***Thy will be done on earth as it is in heaven' before He does what He wills to do*** (Matt. 6: 10). When we understand the immensity of the power God has placed in man, we will know why the course and times of a man's life is never ordered by solely God's predestination but his subject to human choices. God invested so much power in man that though He is sovereign and has the power of predestination; He still subjects Himself to work only through the cooperation and choices of man. The following are some powers that God invested in man:

1. **The Power of Imagination**: At creation, God designed man to have the power of imagination. Thus, man achieves whatever is the object of his imagination. Thus, if a person's imagination is not going in the direction of God's will and predestination for him, God can't but allow the person to go the way of his imagination while God seeks to route His plans through the infinite algorithms of other possibilities to make sure His end is still achieved.

2. **The Power of Intuition**: This is the cognitive ability of man to know beyond what he sees, hears, or receives from his physical senses in the natural. Intuition is an inner knowing and perception that makes a man to pick certain knowledge without natural agencies of communication. Man through intuition is supposed to know that God as God and know His purposes and course for his live. The fundamental things to be known about God and life is placed in man by intuition so that no one would be with excuse (Rom1: 19 -20). Adam knew everything intuitively before the fall but human intuition became dull by the Fall, and it is now only sharpened by correct spiritual partnerships.

3. **The Power of Passion:** Passion is intense emotion expressed through words, actions or attitude. God deposited emotional force into man to help him in actualization of his purpose. When a person's emotion and passion is aligned in the direction of God's will, God is able to ride on it to fulfill His purpose. If one's emotion and passion are released against God's will, God cannot violate it because man was designed to pursue and achieve whatever he is passionate about.

4. **The Power of Reason:** This is one of the most powerful forces God put in man. The power to think logically, make conclusions and draw a course of action. God wants us to man to use his/her own mind and will never violate that power.

5. **The Power of the Conscience:** God puts the power of inner regulation in man so that he can always know right and wrong in life. The conscience of man is the gentle voice that God puts in his spirit to instruct, warn, correct and chastise so that man can be without any excuse with regards to all the power inherent in him. A person's conscience can become defiled, depraved, seared, hardened, evil or dead. When these happen, the person begins to use all the powers invested by God in them against God. Human intuition and conscience makes God to be justified in dealing with humans so that no one can accuse God of unfairness in meting out consequences to people.

6. **The Power of the Will:** This, perhaps, is the height of the power God has given man. The will is the power of choice, volition and self-determination. Man wields this power so consciously that one of his most common daily words is 'I will …" The power of the Will, given to man is one of the greatest expressions of God's love, selflessness, and self-security. The power of the Will has also placed the highest responsibility on man. There is nothing God wants so much that He will use His power to violate the will of the people involved. God respects human will and will never cross the line of going against it in that individual's life. Thus, when the plan, purposes and preordination of God hits against the wall of the will of the person in question, God explores another route and means to achieve His end. God has a predestined end in every matter which will come to pass no matter the means and time it will take. It is good to know that it is not only the course but also the timelines of events that are adaptable to change. Both the course and timelines of events in this world are not cast-in-stone by God's predestination but by the promptness of alignment of human will involved.

Man's Power of Choice

In view of the God-given powers deposited in man as explained, it is obvious that it would be impossible for God to run the world of men by absolute predestination without violating man. So, predestination is real but it is not absolute. Choice is the power of man to exercise his will in any direction he desires and self-determine his outcome in life. Eph. 1:4 - 5 says, ***just as God chose us in Him before the foundation of the world, that we should be holy and without blame before Him in love, having predestined us to adoption as sons by Jesus Christ to Himself, according to the good pleasure of His will***. God predestines a fixed end for the bigger picture that He is working out in every context but the fulfillment in individual lives is neither automatic nor fixed but dependent on individual choices. For example, God predestined salvation for all men but people die daily without being saved - their choice. However, the predestined end will still be achieved. So, God speaks, ***I have sworn by my own name; I have spoken the truth, and I will never go back on my word: Every knee will bend to me, and every tongue will confess allegiance to me.*** (Isa 45:23 NLT) Everyone will eventually bow to the Lordship of Jesus but the place they will be by the time they do is based on their choice. It is better to release your choice right now and bow to His Lordship in this lifetime.

God will achieve whatever He wants to, no matter how long it will take and how many people He will have to pass over until He gets a willing fit for each operation in the algorithm of the codes that needs to be in place for His program to run. He will even create another person for the specific purpose if at all there is no one among the billions on earth exercising their choices in the direction he wants.

Marital Decision: Predestination or Choice?

Understanding the balance between predestination and choices clarifies the topic of God's will in matters - including marriage. The seemingly complex subject of God's marital will among Christians is simplified when we understand how predestination and choices work together in God's operating system. 'God's will' is not a marriage subject, basically, it is a body of knowledge and operating system that should be understood holistically. God has a will and predestination in His assignment and purpose for each person, but it is never cast in stone because anything that involves humans and involves will is given the flexibility of adaption and change by God. So, when God already has a task He wants to achieve, He creates and preordains people with the qualities and attributes suited for the fulfillment of that role. Even in the natural job market, each job role has a fit of qualities, skills and attributes that are suited for it. This is the reason vacancies are advertised and recruitment exercises are conducted because it is not one single person that will be the fit for every needed role. So, choices and considerations need to be made in filling that position. Similarly, God creates many people who have the fit of attribute and qualities for each Kingdom role. Each Kingdom role – including marital roles for children of God - has a particular matrix of persons that God created to be suited for each unique situation by divine preordination. The ones that align by their choices are the ones that God will put in that role. Thus, whether in life, ministry or marriage, there is a kind of person predestined by God for a role (meaning that the qualities necessary for each role are in God's mind as He creates different people with this predestined role in mind).

However, there is no single person such that it is either that person or nothing else works. We must understand that the specifics of each person created by God is based on God's unique assignment and purposes for him/her but there is no one that is predestined to a specific role by name.

Thus, thinking that there is a particular person predestined by name for marriage for another person which if he/she misses, would have eternally missed the will of God is gross misunderstanding. Truly, there is a kind of person predestined for each person in marriage based on the unique assignment and destiny God has for him/her but there is no single person that must be it or no one else. Just like other Kingdom roles, it is the person who aligns with a marital role based on mutual choice among the people suited by God's preordination that gets the job. A curious mind would ask, 'Well, what if more than one person aligns?' Do not worry, in the Kingdom, the roles are infinite and there is a task for everyone - God has an assignment for every willing person. Simply put, if more than one person aligns, God has a spouse for every of His children - that is why choice comes into play.

Therefore, there is predestination in marriage but not in the context which it is being erroneously preached that there is a particular person God created for each one to marry which if one misses, the person has missed the will of God. The actual truth is that there is a matrix of attributes making the kind of person you should marry in order to fulfill destiny. Obviously, people in ministry do not struggle to understand that marrying a person not suited for the role of a minister's spouse can cause ministry failure.

However, this truth does not apply only to people in ministry; there is a kind of person suited in marriage for every destiny based on their life assignment. Marriage is essentially a life assignment discussion. So, you cannot just choose to marry anybody - not even just any believer, there is a form of predestination. However, the predestination is not a name written by God as the person you must marry. Human choices still controls the system. So, the God's will in marriage is that two believers of opposite gender exercise their individual will to marry each other, due to their personal considerations and choices, within the context of God's revealed principles in His Word, and within the limits of the matrix of God's preordination for the involved people based on their understanding of their life assignments.

The Theory of Substitution in Destiny

God predestines end results but the means is subject to change based on the choices of the persons involved. Thus, the predetermined purpose of God will be achieved even if the human agents have to be substituted. We should understand that, just like in a ball game, God has infinite capable substitutes to play every role in his scheme.

Many scriptures point to the fact that Jesus was predestined to die on the cross. Acts 2: 23 says, ***Jesus, being delivered by the predetermined purpose and foreknowledge of God, you have taken by lawless hands, have crucified, and put to death*** (NLT). It was predestined that Jesus Christ would die on the cross and that one of His twelve disciples would be the one to betray him to his death. Thus, Jesus in John 17: 12 says, ***during my time here, I protected them by the power of the name you gave me. I guarded them so that not one was lost, except the one headed for destruction, as the Scriptures foretold.***

Scriptures preordained and foretold that one disciple would betray Jesus; however, the scripture did not write any disciple's name as the one who will be the betrayer. The person who, through his tendencies and choices, partners with the possibility would be the one to commit the treason. Satan, therefore, went around the disciples, trying them one after the other, to see the one that he could use as a betrayer. Satan nearly succeeded with Peter but he was always malleable and open to correction so he always came back whenever he missed it. Satan found the perfect fit for the role in Judas who already had greed and the love of money rooted in his heart. God does not predestine evil for any person. People by their tendencies and warped desires partner with a predestined evil and become the perpetrator of it.

There is always a substitute should a predestined person refuse to align his choice with the predestined purpose or end. Still on the disciples of Jesus, God has predestined that there would be twelve apostles. The number twelve has spiritual significance in God's architecture and the Heavenly Jerusalem, built from the foundation of the world, has twelve foundations, with the names of twelve apostles on it. Thus, when Judas, by his choice, fell out of predestination as a foundational apostle into damnation through treachery, God amply substituted someone else into the role. According to Acts 1:15-22, ***Peter stood up and addressed them, "Brothers," he said, "the Scriptures had to be fulfilled concerning Judas, who guided those who arrested Jesus. This was predicted long ago by the Holy Spirit, speaking through King David. . . "This was written in the book of Psalms, where it says, 'let his home become desolate, with no one living in it.' It also says, 'Let someone else take his position.'***

"***So now we must choose a replacement for Judas from among the men who were with us the entire time we were traveling with the Lord Jesus . . .*** Someone else was substituted to fulfill the preordination to be the twelfth apostolic pillar of the Church.

The family of Eli was also substituted out of priesthood due to the choices, tendencies and attitudes of the family members. 1 Samuel 2:30-36 records, therefore, the Lord, the God of Israel, says: ***I promised that your branch of the tribe of Levi would always be my priests. But I will honor those who honor me, and I will despise those who think lightly of me. The time is coming when I will put an end to your family, so it will no longer serve as my priests. . . . Then I will raise up a faithful priest who will serve me and do what I desire. I will establish his family, and they will be priests to my anointed kings forever . . .*** God had predestined Eli's lineage to be perpetual priests but He later changed his mind and brought in a substitute to fulfill the preordination of priesthood.

In partnering with predestination, the keywords are "tendencies and choices." God keenly considers people's tendencies and respects their choices. The classic explanation of the mix of preordination and choices is found in the story of Esau and Jacob. In Gen. 25:23, predestination was recorded when God said to Rebekah, ***"The sons in your womb will become two nations. From the very beginning, the two nations will be rivals. One nation will be stronger than the other; and your older son will serve your younger son.*** People have asked if God was rather unfair in predestining one child to be greater than the other, when neither have even lived or done anything. Rom. 9:10-15 addressed the sentiment; '… ***Our ancestor Isaac, when he married Rebekah, she gave birth to twins. But before they were born, before they had done anything good or bad,***

she received a message from God. (This message shows that God chooses people according to his own purposes; He calls people, but not according to their good or bad works.) She was told, "Your older son will serve your younger son." In the words of the Scriptures, "I loved Jacob, but I rejected Esau." Are we saying, then, that God was unfair? Of course not! We must remember that God's preordination is still subject to the tendencies and choices of the people involved. God is sovereign but limits the expression of His sovereignty in individual lives to the context of the power of their choices and will.

Reading through the eventual lives of Esau and Jacob, one would see that God knew what He saw before He predicted that the older would be less than the younger. Before their birth, God, through His eternal eyes, had foreseen the tendencies of Esau to marry strange girls, adopt the hunting profession of the surrounding unbelievers over the shepherding work of his ancestors, value food, sex and physical gratification over spiritual inheritance, despise his birthday and esteem the covenant lightly. All his tendencies and choices released the forces that made him lose out of the greatness that was available to him. If He had taken the prophecy to heart and determined to exercise his choices toward God and the covenant, the story would have ended differently. As established already, predestination does not mean something is bound to happen anyways. Every man is given a level of control over his destiny by his choices. Positive predestination has to be followed by closely aligning ones choice with what has been written. Negative predestination could be averted by aligning one's choices against it. Remember, it is the end result that God has in mind in predestination and not necessarily the person.

God had predestined the Covenant Seed (Jesus Christ) would come through a man. Abraham aligned His choices with that and became the carrier of that heritage. He passed the covenant to Isaac who chose to walk with the God of his father Abraham. Isaac had two children and the blessed lineage has to pass through one of them. God, with His infinite eyes, read into the tendencies, choice and value-systems of the two embryos and noticed that the younger one was a better fit by his tendencies and potential lifestyle to be the carrier of the covenant so He released the prophecy of preordination. Was it still possible for Esau to have carried the predestination of the Messianic lineage? Absolutely! -If he had discovered the prophecy at stake, prayerfully insisted that he must carry the covenant; lived a life totally aligned with the demands of the covenant lineage and aligned his tendencies, choices and attitudes with the demands of the covenant.. God is not unjust, He would not make Jacob rule over Esau if Esau lived a life more covenant compliant than Jacob. A curious mind would ask, 'what if both of them lived covenant worthy lives?' Just as previously answered, 'God has infinite ways to achieve His purpose and there is a role for every willing person in achieving God's predestined end result'.

Substitution in Marriage

Relating the concept of substitution in predestination and choices to marriage, we have understood that there is no person that if a single man or lady does not marry, he/she would have missed God's will for their life. Even if God speaks to you explicitly about someone and the relationship does not work – either the person is unwilling or the human imperfections and choices of the involved party makes the relationship not to work, God has someone else with the same destiny matrix for the

involved parties to still fulfill their purposes. This should make every unmarried lady and young man secure - your destiny is not tied to anyone - God has infinite substitutes with which you can fulfill destiny. The only time two destinies become tied is when they have actually entered into a marriage covenant with each other. However, many believers try to tie their destinies to abusive and non-working courtships because they claimed God spoke to them that that person is their spouse. Worst case, is when one bases his/her conviction on the fact that the other person claimed that God spoke to them that you are to be their spouse. What many do not understand is that when someone says God spoke to him/her that you are the one they should marry, even if that statement is true, God is merely showing you that such a person fits into the matrix of the qualities and attributes that is suited for the fulfillment of your assignment in destiny based on his divine preordination and understanding of both of you. He is merely presenting the person to you as He did the creatures to Adam. God presented all the animals to Adam and waited for Adam to choose one as wife. Reading through Genesis 2: 18 - 25, one would see that God never choose Eve as Adam's wife. He created Eve and brought her to Adam just as He did all the animals. Adam saw the monkey and called it monkey but saw Eve and called her wife (the Hebrew word translated 'woman' in Gen. 2: 23 is the word, 'ishshah' and it is the same word for 'wife'). Thus, when Adam saw Eve at creation, He chose her as his wife. Gen. 2: 23 - 24 shows this, ***"At last!" the man exclaimed. "This one is bone from my bone, and flesh from my flesh! She will be called 'woman'*** (ishshah - correct translation should be 'wife'), ***because she was taken from 'man.'" This explains why a man leaves his father and mother and is joined to his wife*** (same word 'ishshah' translated here as wife), ***and the***

two are united into one. This is the account of Adam's choice of a marriage partner from one human and many animals. The principle is still the same today. God predestined Eve as Adam's wife and Adam chose Eve as His wife.

The choices people make are the determinants which God respects, honors, and works with in their entering into marriage. So, if a young man/lady that you are not yet married to is not willing, not complying with your destiny or the relationship is absolutely unworkable, stop binding yourself to that relationship as if your destiny is tied to him/her. Furthermore, people should stop claiming that God chose a spouse for them. God has never chosen a spouse for anyone and never will. Choice, intrinsically, is a power inherent in man. God cannot choose for you more than He can eat for you. God can help you in making a choice but He cannot choose for you. At best, God presented (or suggested) that person and you chose him/her and at worst, you are lying (either in sincerity of heart due to ignorance or insincerely due to hardness of heart). Some people claim that God chose for them when God neither suggested nor chose – they did both - and now that things are not working, they are pushing the blame on God.

It is important to understand that success in marriage is based on the partners' understanding and compliance with Kingdom principles of laws of living together and not on the fact that there are particular persons that must be together in the marriage for it to work. In other words, success in marriage is not based on the fact that there are two people that must be together to have a happy home but on whether the two people married are running their home by God's principles or not. Thus, marriage does not succeed because A married B or because C married D. If A did not marry B but married D, and A and D run their home by God's principles, the home will be peaceful, joyful and successful as when A married B and they run the home by God's principle and not on particular persons involved so that the law of

substitution can be potent without compromising marital success. So, you can marry someone and fulfill destiny and even have a happy and successful marriage by basing your home on Kingdom principles, however, the same result will suffice if anything happens and you eventually married the substitute. You are not bound to inevitably marry a particular person as a single. This brings freedom and liberty of choice in marriage to every child of God. However, remember as we established earlier, that this choice is to be considered within the limits of your understanding of God's predestination matrix of your life. This is why it is still valid and important to pray very well before making a marital choice. This is because the preordination matrix component of the suitability of a potential person for marriage cannot be absolutely discerned by human observation or calculation; it is a component that only God has the full details. Thus, it is vital to pray to seek God's mind, hear the details He has to reveal and not base our choice on human permutations. The truth is that in anything that has to do with humans, the best of your guess may be very wrong. Even people do not know themselves totally, how much another person knowing them absolutely. This is the reason we pray and seek God on the issue of marriage but eventually you must make the choice – make sure the choice is in alignment with what God has revealed to you. For those that are married already, this working principle applies to every area of life decision making in our walk with God.

Understanding Destiny

Destiny is God's plan concerning you which exists even before your existence. To fulfill destiny, you need to need to discover God's mind about every area of your life and then align your will and choices towards it. Prayer is one of the highest wisdom for living – above all other applications; it is the tool for discovering God's mind, will and preordination for your every area of your destiny.

You cannot just choose any course, path or thing in life as you wish. You need to discover God's mind concerning the things of your life and partner your choices along with the discovered course. Also, it is important to know that if a particular course is not yours to fulfill, no amount of exertion and choice can make you fulfill it. Wasted efforts in destiny, at times, are due to pursuing a course that is out of preordination for one. It does not mean that one may not even succeed in that course in material terms but even at that, it is still an eternal waste of effort. As commonly said, success in the wrong assignment is still failure. So, the first step in destiny is to prayerfully discover God's preordination for one. This is what the entire premise of the Volume One of this book is about.

Having discovered God's planned course for your life, it is crucial to note that it is not automatic, you have to consistently align your choices in the direction of God's preordination for your life to fulfill destiny. For predestination to be fulfilled, a person needs to play his own part. Thus, man is the truly determinant of his destiny by his choices. Predestination and choices are like two wheels of a bicycle - predestination is the front wheel and choices are the rear wheel. Remove one and realize how helpless the other is.

Predestination sets the course of life and choices order the course of life. It is important to pay great attention to the course of our lives and make sure it is trending in the positive direction. This is done by the choices we make at every point in our lives. How far one would go in the direction of preordination is also dependent on our choices. It is one thing for God to predestine you for an assignment; it is another thing to be successful in that assignment. Put differently, even along the path of your predestination, your choices determine how far you would go. For instance, if God says you will be rich, it is your choice that determines whether you will be a millionaire, billionaire or trillionaire.

So, if you have discovered your destiny, you also have to choose how far you want to go in fulfilling it.

For instance, if a person who is predestined to go into academics but due to nonchalance and wrong choices finishes school with a pass, that person may be limited more than someone who graduated with a first class. Also, if two people are called into the academia and one chooses to make the sacrifices to bag a doctoral degree, he will go further that the person who stopped at a first degree. God ordains but people decide. In essence, direction is a destiny discovery. Achievement, success and greatness in such discovery are parameters of choice.

When you discover and understand your destiny, choices and decisions of life become easier. Whether marriage choices or profession choices, all is premised on the purpose discovered.

CHAPTER 5

THE TIME-LINE OF LIFE

Along the route of a journey, there are sign posts on the way. Some of these show direction while some reinforce assurance that one is on course. Therefore, if one sets out for Lagos, drives for 4 hours along a Nigerian road and sees a sign reading, 'Lagos 1000 Km Ahead', he knows that he is headed in the right direction. It is when you set out for Lagos and after driving for 6 hours, you see a sign reading, 'Abuja 1000 Km Ahead, Kaduna 1500 Km Ahead' that you know there is a problem. Along the course of life, there are landmarks and milestones that show progress and success in life.

It is important to know that progress in the realm of life is measured by growth and not the passage of time. The signposts along the course of life are events. Landmark events at every point indicate progress along the course of life. The fact that one has marked spent many years is not necessarily a measure of progress. The measure of progress along the time-line of life is what progressive events have happened in those years. This is the error of those who pride themselves in the chronological passage of time and claim seniority based on age and not results.There are people who claim 'spiritual seniority' because they have been born again for 35 years. They are not aware that such concepts do not exist in the realm of the spirit. In the realm of life, the measure of progress along the timeline is events, milestones and achievements.

So before you boast that you got born again in 1965 before the pastor was born, what impact have you made for the kingdom? How far have you gone in fulfilling your Kingdom purpose? At what spiritual heights are you operating now based on the results you are commanding in the realm of life for the Kingdom? These parameters are what measure progress in the spirit and not the passage of chronological time. Age, in the realm of the spirit and in life, is measured by progressive growth, impact and attainment, not by the passage of time.

This understanding makes one to be result-oriented in life and in spiritual pursuits. There are milestone achievements along the course of your life that shows that you are growing and making progress in life. Staying at one point without progressive achievement shows you are not moving in life. A 25 year old that is born-again, has discovered purpose and is actively pursuing it, probably happily married and successfully building a godly family, financially doing well and probably a multi-millionaire, and is making impact for God's kingdom is 'older' than the 40-year-old that is moving around life with nothing working – no purpose, no job, no working marriage, zero finance, worse off, a liability to everyone around. Real age is not measured in life by measured by the passage of time but progress along the time-lines of life.

Similarly, age in the spirit is not measured by how long one has been in the faith but by spiritual accomplishment in the direction of God's purpose and preordination for your life. Salvation is the gate to the Kingdom. There are people that got born-again 35 years ago and have not left the gate but sat at the gate-post. While there are people who got born again two years ago and have gone far in exploring the lifestyle of the Kingdom.

Don't fall into the self-deception of rating how long you have been born-again, when you joined church or how long you have been a minister. What accomplishments, impact and milestones are you achieving and landmark are you crossing in life. What additional accomplishment did you have this year. Stagnation is years passing without additional life accomplishment.

Concepts of Time-Line in Life - Chronos and Kairos

There are many Greek words translated as 'time' in the English Bible. However, three of such words carry strong imports to the context of the discussion on understanding at the timelines of life. The words Chronos, Kairos and Aeon, among others, are translated as time in the Bible and carry different diminution and significances. Adequate understanding of these words helps in conveying the significance of timing and timelines in life.

The Greek Word 'Chronos' (Strong NT 5550) talks about the passage of time and a progression of space of time. This is the etymological root of the word chronological. Chronos, as a concept, describes the continuous passage of time in life. What you do with the chronological passage of every second, minute, hour, day and year of your life determines where your life is headed. In fact, Chronos is the most important time concept in determining the outcome of your life because your life essentially is a summation of what you do with the chronos of life

However, another powerful concept of time is revealed by the Greek word **Kairos** (Strong NT:165) which describes a particular point in time or period. The word Kairos is usually translated in the context of an appointed time, particular time or set time.

It is important to maximize the chronological passage of time in your life but we must be wise to know that not all times carry equal significance in life. There are Kairos moments when something that can change your life presents itself before you. The word Kairos is also translated 'opportunity' is several places in the Bible. Missing Kairos is one of the reasons for failure in life and maximizing Kairos is one of the hallmarks of a great man in life. Do not waste your chronos, spend it doing things that move you forward in destiny. Both Chronos and Kairos need to be maximized for life to attain its fullest potential. The daily passage of time in your life is to be used judiciously and definite moments need to be capitalized upon.

When people sleep and play all day, squander time on things that are irrelevant to destiny, invest time in unproductive relationships and activities, they are squandering the Chronos of their lives. It is actually with Chronos that you prepare for Kairos. Chronos is the real powerhouse of life because if Chronos is not maximized, Kairos comes and it meets no prepared foundation in place to deliver its expected results. How you spend your time daily is the real differential of your destiny. In Heb. 4:7, Bible says, *again He designates a certain day, saying in David, "Today," after such a long time (Chronos), as it has been said: "Today, if you will hear His voice, do not harden your hearts."* For a long chronos, there was no urgent visitation but wise people maximize their chronos till a kairos comes with an opportunity. According to John 5:2-4, ***Now there is in Jerusalem by the Sheep Gate a pool, which is called in Hebrew, Bethesda, having five porches. 3 In these lay a great multitude of sick people, blind, lame, paralyzed, waiting for the moving of the water. For an angel went down at a certain time (Kairos) into the pool and stirred up the water; then whoever stepped in first, after the stirring of the water, was made well of whatever disease he had.***

Kairos times are life changing moments, how you respond to opportune time is a direct prediction of how far your life will go. There are conversations, people, openings, meetings or requests that present you with Kairos moments. All times are not the same, recognizing and discerning time is a hallmark of wisdom. Eph. 5:15-18 captures the thought well, *see then that you walk circumspectly, not as fools but as wise, redeeming the time (Kairos), because the days are evil. Therefore do not be unwise, but understand what the will of the Lord is.* Some translations substitute the phrase 'redeeming the time' with 'making the most of opportunity'. The word Kairos means opportune time, set time, or a particular time. There will always come a particular time when your life will change if you discern correctly the time and maximize the moment by doing what you need to do promptly. Some people are wasting their daily Chronos, slacking and dishonoring Kairos moments and wondering why nothing is happening in their life your lifetime is determined by your use of your time in life.

The last word of interest is the word, Aeion (Greek NT 165) and it means an age, dispensation or period. It is used to denote lifespans, decades, centuries, millennia, or eternity. The word is translated as 'forever and ever' in some contexts. Eph. 3:21 says *Unto him be glory in the church by Christ Jesus throughout all ages (Genea), world without end (Aeion to Aeion). Amen.* Col. 1:26 says, even the mystery which hath been hid from ages (Aeion) and from generations (Genea), but now is made manifest to his saints.

If you view the Aeion as your lifetime, then Chronos is the timeline along your lifetime and Kairos presents opportunities for milestones and events that make your life. It is important to know that you have a role to play in determining the timings of your life.

Do you know that even the time of attainment of things in life is not solely by God's predestination? It is also by choice. Many times, the timelines of events are delayed not because God does not want them to happen yet but because the human factors have not properly aligned. People excuse things not happening for them by saying, 'God's time is the best' when God is actually waiting for them to align and make the time happen. If we do not maximise the times of life - the Chronos and Kairos, the Aeion (the lifetime) suffers for it. Things do not happen and we think that it is because it is not yet time by God's calendar whereas it is because we have not made it happen by our engagement of time here on earth.

Waiting Times and Appointed Times

There are Kairos moments in destiny. Appointed times are not every time – there are specific times when destiny comes knocking, and opening the door and apprehending it could mean the difference between failure and success forever. This is why it is important to know how to persevere and wait till your appointed time comes. Job 14:14 says, '*... all the days of my appointed time will I wait, till my change come*'.

Waiting time is an integral part of the times of life, unfortunately the concept of waiting time has been grossly misunderstood by many and it has led to gross limitations in destiny. Milestones and events of life are delivered at appointed times but in-between appointed moments are the waiting times. According to Hab. 2:3, *for the vision is yet for an appointed time, but at the end it shall speak, and not lie: though it tarry, wait for it; because it will surely come, it will not tarry*. Waiting time is simply the Chronos in between the Kairos moments. Many people think waiting means staying in a limbo in expectation of something from God

while doing nothing.

There are people who finish school doing nothing and when asked, they say they are waiting for a job. The concept of waiting doing nothing is an abuse of life. Waiting time is simply the Chronos that leads to the Kairos you are expecting. The grossest misunderstanding is displayed when someone says they are waiting on God and they are not doing anything but praying, reading Bible and largely sleeping while not working at anything productive with their lives. Therefore, for every expectation in life, there must be something you are doing actively in preparing for the opportune moment. Waiting actually is whatever you are busy doing in anticipation of the Kairos moment you are expecting. Therefore, you can be waiting to start the vision or call upon your life while you are busy working at a job or serving in an existing vision. You are waiting for a job while you are in school or studying a postgraduate course. You are waiting to start your business while you are working as an employee under someone doing a similar thing. A person is waiting for marriage while busy putting structures of establishment in place for his/her life. Waiting is not a passive state; it is an active state of life. In fact, everyone in life is waiting. The millionaire is waiting to become a billionaire so she is busy every day working at her million dollar business while waiting and praying for that big break - the appointed time – that launches her into the billion level. The medical student is waiting to become a medical doctor and is aware that it is the quality of her investment and performance in this 'waiting period' as a student that determines the quality of her prospect at the appointed time after graduation. Waiting periods are busy period, not sleeping period. Anyone who is doing nothing and claims he/she is waiting, is actually wasting and dying.

People say they are waiting on God while God is waiting for them. It is

what you are doing now that will lead to what you will do next. It is the Chronos that leads to the Kairos – so the waiting time leads to the appointed time. When the waiting time is spent doing nothing, the appointed time has no in-flow to make it happen. Waiting time is actually the preparation time before any breakthrough. Therefore, appointed times can be triggered by the quality of maximization of the preparing time. God is the one that appoints time. Isa. 61:1-3 is a prophecy about Jesus Christ*, the Spirit of the Lord God is upon me; because the Lord hath anointed me to proclaim the acceptable year of the Lord, and the day of vengeance of our God; to comfort all that mourn; to appoint unto them that mourn in Zion,*

God is the one who appoints time. Ex 9:5 says*, the Lord appointed a set time, saying, tomorrow the Lord shall do this thing in the land.* God is the God of appointed times. However, we have also seen men appoint times. Examples are Elijah in 1 Kings 17 who declared that rain would not fall for the next three and a half years until he changes the time and Elisha in 2 Kings 7:1-2 who decreed that the famine would end the next day.

The power of the prophetic is changing times and season is untold. Therefore, you can hold to a prophetic word from God and on the strength of that and enforce a Kairos moment on your life. Faith and prayers are spiritual forces for birthing forth an appointed time. Therefore, if the appointed time seems not to be coming, having labored in prayers over the issue, I can rise up in faith and by the Spirit of God declare that my appointed time has come. According to Psa. 102: 13, *You will arise and have mercy on Zion; For the time to favor her, Yes, the set time, has come.* You can ride on the strength of faith in God's word, decide that your appointed time is now and insist on it until you get.

When working out your faith for an appointed time, an integral component of that faith walk is that you channel the waiting time to putting everything in place like someone sure that the appointed time has come. Thus, for instance, if you have prayed, received the Word of God, and you believe that your appointed time for child-birth has come, you should quit waiting passively and convert the waiting period to the preparation period for your baby's birth. God gives a provision in the spirit for man to appoint his/her own time but then it must be by faith and the faith is best evidenced in how you use the waiting period after you have decreed yourself an appointed time.

Missing Timings in Life

One of the worst things in life and the most common cause of life failure is missing timing in life. Some people fail in life because they did not get what to do right. Some fail because they did not get the timing of their lives right. Ps. 32:9 says, ***do not be like the horse or the mule, which have no understanding but must be controlled by bit and bridle or they will not come to you.*** The horse and the mule do not have understanding of time so they get bloodied mouths. The bridle and bits used on horses and oxen are very painful instruments as they are yoked to their mouth system to control them. The problem with the horse is that it does not understand timing so it has high propensity to be too fast for its owner, so the rider puts a painful bit in its mouth to slow it down and control it. The mule, on its own part, used to plough the farm, has no understanding of timing so it is too slow for the farmer. So, they use the yoke in its mouth to drag it. The pain of yoking any animal's mouth is extreme. It is only imaginable when you consider it to be your mouth where those iron or wooden pegs are driven and connect to a haul which is used to either drag you forward or backward. The pain of not understanding timing in life is equally

immense. Whether one runs ahead in destiny or slows down unnecessarily in destiny, the pain is always failure or regrets. The only way to enjoy destiny is to be in pace with your life. This happens when you accurately sense the timings of your life.

It is not just important to know what God wants you to do. You must always ask God when. It is a disaster to run ahead when God does not yet say to move. It is equally a calamity to stay when God has already told you to move. You must make sure your destiny is in sync with God's will. We get timings right in life, when we are people devoted to prayers.

Missing timings in life can lead to irrecoverable loss. In Luke 19:41 - 44, Jesus wept over Jerusalem and said, "***If you, even you, had only known on this day what would bring you peace — but now it is hidden from your eyes. The days will come upon you when your enemies will build an embankment against you and encircle you and hem you in on every side. They will dash you to the ground, you and the children within your walls. They will not leave one stone on another, because you did not recognize the time of God's coming to you***" (NIV). The entire catastrophe that befell them was because they did not recognize their appointed time came and they missed timing in life. You have to be diligent in maximizing your Chronos, you have to be really prayerful and daily at alert. If Kairos comes and one missed it, one may never recover or may have to wait untold number of years in pain because one missed timing; either moving when it was time to staying or staying when it was time to move.

God's Assignment - The Kingdom

Life is all about Times and Seasons. Living a great life is all about maximizing each season of life.

A common mistake in life is people wishing and praying for a great life while neglecting to greatly utilize the season of life they are in. A great live is simply a sum total of greatness of each season of life. There is no how that one can make something great out of life in the absence of a profound understanding of all ramifications of time in life as portrayed in this book. Healthy relationship with time in all its ramifications is a principal determinant of success and fulfillment in life.

Eccl. 9:11 ***says I have seen something else under the sun. The race is not to the swift or the battle to the strong, nor does food come to the wise or wealth to the brilliant or favor to the learned; but time and chance happen to them all.*** (NIV). God's wisdom in this scripture listed all the parameters that make for success in life: strength, brilliance, skills, education and many other things but concluded by saying that beyond all these, the singular determinant of success is timing and opportunity. A strong or talented person who is not aligned with timing in destiny will always be behind the weaker or less talented person who always gets the timings of his/her right.

CHAPTER 6

RESTORATION OF TIME AND SEASON IN LIFE

Due Season

There is something as due season in life. Ps. 1:3 says, ***and he shall be like a tree planted by the rivers of water, that bringeth forth his fruit in his season; his leaf also shall not wither; and whatsoever he doeth shall prosper.***

There is a due season for everything in life. When the time you should have had a result is passed and it is not forthcoming, it should become an issue of concern. Delay, belated life and denial are satanic strategies for causing failure in life. If time is going and the milestones are not coming, then such life is running behind schedule and unless there is divine intervention, failure or short-changing of destiny is imminent. We should demand for the fruits of our life in due season. When it is time to get a thing in life, then it must be demanded from life.

For instance, it is not just important to be established and helped in life. It is important that it happens early. Ps. 46:5 says, ***God is in the midst of her; she shall not be moved: God shall help her, and that right early.*** When seasons are delayed and fruits are belated, they cost a person's destiny so much. The best of life is in things happening at the right time and milestones being achieved right early in life – at the right time.

There is a right time to build a house - it is not with your gratuity after retirement when your children are already on their way out to get married and start their own families. There is a right time to be rich, married, start your vision or ministry. There is a due season for every fruit. Wisdom is knowing the achievement, milestone that is due in your life by now and going for it and not just leaving your life to chance and coursing through life, expecting things to happen when they want to. You should know that by God's calendar for my life, I should be a millionaire by now. I should have started my vision by now. I should be married with children. You have to know the chronos timetable of God for your life and insist on Kairos moments to deliver the milestones that are due along spiritual timeline of your life as revealed by God's timetable/calendar of your life

Zech. 10:1 says, ***Ask ye of the Lord rain in the time of the latter rain; so the Lord shall make bright clouds, and give them showers of rain, to every one grass in the field***. When you see that it is supposed to be time for rain in your life and the rain is not coming, you had better started praying and fasting for rain. Do not leave life to chance, when you see that it is time for anything to happen and it is not happening, you must take spiritual responsibility and start demanding from heaven that the times of your life be aligned with God's calendar for you.

Being out of Season

There is not only what God wants you to do in life, there is a calendar of progress he has for you. Satan tries all his best to prevent people from discovering what they should do with their lives. The moment he has failed by one giving his/her life to Christ and discovering purpose and destiny. One strong strategy he has left is to resist the path so much that one's preordained timeline is slowed down. This is because there are two ways to fail an exam: not knowing the right answers or knowing the right answers but not having enough time to answer them. So, if satan sees that he has failed in derailing a person's course of life, he will insist on resisting their time of line. According to Rev.12:12, Satan has a short time so he understands the disadvantage that shortness of time

Thus, he fights people on the issue of time. Begin to pray vehemently about the times of your life and insist on certain things that must happen at certain times. Do not take the issue of time gently in life; so many people are failing because the enemy is winning them on the issue of time. Clichés like 'God's time is the best', 'it is all well that ends well', 'e go better - tomorrow will be better', etc. have made many people to be deceived by the enemy not to know that we are in a warfare over the time of our life. Today, insist in the name of Jesus that now is the time for your breakthrough, marriage, business and ministry to start, or any other thing for that matter that you know should be due in your life right now.

Restoration of Wasted Time - The Mercy of God

Time is one commodity that once it is gone, you can never have it back. You may have another opportunity another time but that one that was squandered is gone. Every one has 24 hours in a day and for every time that is wasted, a part of life is gone. This is the reason one of satan's strategies of warfare is to fight your times of life. If satan cannot stop you, he will do all he can to delay you. He knows for every time you spend in stagnation unable to proceed, he has won a part of your life. Thus, praying for God to deliver for you on time is a vital warfare prayer in destiny.

Even the times that has been squandered in the time past by ignorance, disobedience and satanic siege can be recovered by the mercy of God. When God restores the time of your life, He takes you to where you should be right now had it been there was no disadvantage at any point of your timeline in destiny. It is important to pray for recovery of time, especially if things have happened in the time past that have slowed, derailed or delayed the time and course of your life at any point.

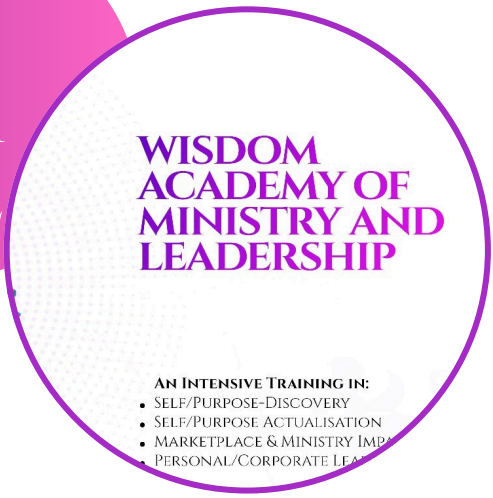
God says in Joel 2:25 - 27, ***and I will restore to you the years that the locust hath eaten, the cankerworm, and the caterpillar, and the palmer worm, my great army which I sent among you. And ye shall eat in plenty, and be satisfied, and praise the name of the Lord your God, that hath dealt wondrously with you: and my people shall never be ashamed. And ye shall know that I am in the midst of Israel, and that I am the Lord your God, and none else: and my people shall never be ashamed.*** Today, every shame is wiped away from your life and every lost time is recovered in Jesus name.

Time lost can be recovered only by the mercy of GOD. Psa. 102: 13 says, ***You will arise and have mercy on Zion; For the time to favor her, Yes, the set time, has come.*** It is time to cry out for mercy over the times of your life. Every time of your life that was lost, squandered or stolen by the enemy is restored by the mercy of God in Jesus name.

Conclusively, a great course in the School of Wisdom is the course on time. Wisdom is knowing what to do, when to do it, how to do it, with whom to do it, and where to do it. Failure can ensue by missing any out of these five adverbs of wisdom, even when you get the others right.

So never forget to keep the brevity of your lifetime in perpetual view and go all out to maximize life. Two scriptural reference that should guide your life in relating with your time of life are **'*Lord, please teach us to realize the brevity of life so that we may grow in wisdom the time of your life*.'** (Ps. 90:12 NLT) and '***know the importance of the season you're in and a wise son you will be. But what a waste when an incompetent son.'*** **(**Prov 10: 5).

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ABOUT THE BOOK

In living a life of fulfilment and meaning, it is not just sufficient to know what to do in life, it is important to know when to do it. A sequel to the book 'The Life Assignment' by the same author, which answers the question of WHAT you are on earth to do, this book gives insights the question of WHEN. By reading this book you will develop wisdom on how to live a fulfilled life by understanding and aligning with accurate timing for each step of life.



ABOUT THE AUTHOR

Davids Oluwaseye Ayodele is a trainer, speaker and writer. He is graced with understanding and presenting complex issues with simplicity and clarity for practical application.

He is the founder of several initiatives both within the Church and the workplace, such as The Wisdom Institute of Leadership and Ministry for training and equipping Church leaders, ENABLED Multiconcept for business and professional leadership development and consultancy, as well as several other platforms for Bible-based Teaching Ministry. He has a bachelor's degree in chemical engineering and master's degree in engineering management from Ahmadu Bello University, Nigeria. He is married to Deborah OluwaNifemi and they are blessed with children.